THE HANDBOOK CHECK

Where do I start?

The Handbook is not a course you must read from page 1. It is a map of everything a pianist reads, hears and plays. This check finds the chapters you already know and the ones to study, so you start exactly where you are.

How it works

1

Choose a part

New to music? Start with Part I. Otherwise begin with the part you need, or do all eight, one part at a time (about 5 minutes each).

2

Answer three questions

for each chapter: circle A, B or C. No book, no piano, no guessing: if you don't know, leave it.

3

Mark and map it

Check with the answers on the last pages, write your score, then colour the chapter on your map (page 15).

What your score means

3 RIGHT

Skip it

You know this chapter. Glance at its secret and move on.

2 RIGHT

Skim it

Read the chapter's opening picture and Examples; check the one you missed.

0 OR 1 RIGHT

Study it

Start here: read the whole chapter and do its workbook pages.

An example

Ex Sample chapter: the musical alphabet Handbook p.22

1 After G, the musical alphabet goes on with...
(A) H (B) A (C) C

2 How many different letter names are there?
(A) 7 (B) 8 (C) 12

3 Going down from C, the next letter is...
(A) D (B) A (C) B

Right: 3 / 3 3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.22

For teachers

Give one part as a ten-minute warm-up at the first lesson. The map shows at a glance which chapters to set, and repeating the check each term shows progress chapter by chapter.

Online: the same check marks itself and draws your map: Library › Handbook check.

Part I · Pitch

P1 The keyboard

Handbook p.22

1 The white key just left of a group of two black keys is...
(A) C (B) D (C) F

2 The white key just left of a group of three black keys is...
(A) F (B) C (C) G

3 Moving to the right on the keyboard, the notes get...
(A) lower (B) louder (C) higher

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.22

P2 The staff and the clefs

Handbook p.27

1 The treble clef curls round the line for...
(A) G (B) C (C) F

2 The two dots of the bass clef hug the line for...
(A) G (B) F (C) A

3 How many lines does a staff have?
(A) 4 (B) 5 (C) 6

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.27

P3 The staff and the keyboard

Handbook p.29

1 Moving up one line or space on the staff moves you...
(A) one black key up (B) one white key up (C) two white keys up

2 From a line to the next line up is...
(A) an octave (B) a skip (a 3rd) (C) a step (a 2nd)

3 Bass F (between the bass clef's dots) and treble G (where the treble clef curls) are...
(A) next-door keys (B) the same distance either side of Middle C (C) the same key

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.29

P4 Reading the notes

Handbook p.32

1 In the treble clef, the bottom line is...
(A) F (B) G (C) E

2 In the treble clef, the spaces from the bottom spell...
(A) E G B D (B) F A C E (C) A C E G

3 Middle C is written...
(A) on the top line of the treble staff (B) on a ledger line between the two staves
(C) in the middle of the bass staff

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.32

P5 Sharps, flats and naturals

Handbook p.36

1 A sharp moves a note...
(A) one key to the right (B) one key to the left (C) one octave up

2 A sharp written in front of a note lasts...
(A) until the end of the bar (B) for that one note only (C) for the whole piece

3 F♯ and G♭ are...
(A) one key with two names (B) two different keys (C) both white keys

Right: ☐ / 3 **3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.36**

P6 Counting intervals

Handbook p.39

1 C up to E is a...
(A) 3rd (B) 2nd (C) 4th

2 C up to G is a...
(A) 4th (B) 5th (C) 6th

3 D up to the next D is a...
(A) 7th (B) 9th (C) octave (8th)

Right: ☐ / 3 **3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.39**

P7 Major, minor and perfect

Handbook p.42

1 A major 3rd has how many keys in between?
(A) 3 (B) 4 (C) 2

2 A perfect 5th has how many keys in between?
(A) 5 (B) 7 (C) 6

3 C up to E♭ is a...
(A) major 3rd (B) minor 3rd (C) perfect 4th

Right: ☐ / 3 **3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.42**

Part II · Time

T1 Pulse, tempo and the bar

Handbook p.47

1 The steady beat underneath the music is the...
(A) pulse (B) melody (C) rhythm

2 In each bar, the strongest beat is usually...
(A) beat 2 (B) beat 1 (C) the last beat

3 The speed of the beat is the...
(A) pitch (B) tempo (C) key

Right: ☐ / 3 **3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.47**

T2 Notes and rests

Handbook p.50

1 In 4/4, a minim lasts...
(A) 1 beat (B) 2 beats (C) 4 beats

2 How many quavers make one crotchet?
(A) 4 (B) 2 (C) 3

3 A semibreve rest can mean...
(A) a whole bar of silence (B) half a beat of silence (C) one beat of silence

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.50

T3 How long is a note?

Handbook p.53

1 A dotted minim lasts...
(A) 3 beats (B) 2 beats (C) 4 beats

2 A dotted crotchet lasts...
(A) 1½ beats (B) 1 beat (C) 2 beats

3 Two notes of the same pitch joined by a tie: you...
(A) play once and hold for both (B) play both (C) play the second louder

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.53

T4 Time signatures

Handbook p.56

1 In 3/4, the top number means...
(A) three beats in each bar (B) three bars on each line (C) three quavers in each beat

2 In 2/4, the bottom number 4 means each beat is a...
(A) minim (B) quaver (C) crotchet

3 Which fills one bar of 3/4?
(A) a minim and a crotchet (B) two minims (C) a semibreve

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.56

T5 Compound and irregular time

Handbook p.59

1 In compound time each beat divides into...
(A) four (B) two (C) three

2 At most speeds, a bar of 6/8 has...
(A) 2 beats (B) 3 beats (C) 6 beats

3 Which time signature is compound?
(A) 3/4 (B) 2/2 (C) 9/8

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.59

T6 Rhythm: groups and upbeats

Handbook p.62

1 A triplet is…
(A) three beats in a bar (B) three tied notes (C) three notes in the time of two

2 An upbeat (anacrusis) is…
(A) a loud first beat (B) notes before the first full bar (C) the last note of a piece

3 In 4/4, which pair of beats may NOT share one beam?
(A) beats 1 and 2 (B) beats 3 and 4 (C) beats 2 and 3

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.62

T7 Rhythm: off the beat

Handbook p.65

1 Syncopation means…
(A) every note is short (B) the music gets faster (C) the stress falls off the beat

2 Swing quavers are played…
(A) short–long (B) long–short (C) exactly even

3 A hemiola makes two bars of 3/4 feel like…
(A) one bar of 6/8 (B) four beats of one (C) three big beats of two (three minims)

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.65

T8 Repeats and road signs

Handbook p.68

1 |: A B :| C — you play…
(A) A B C A B C (B) A B C (C) A B A B C

2 D.C. al Fine means…
(A) go back to the sign (B) go back to the start and stop at Fine (C) play faster to the end

3 With 1st and 2nd time bars, the second time through you…
(A) skip the 1st-time bar (B) play only the 1st-time bar (C) play both

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.68

Part III · Expression

E1 Loud and soft

Handbook p.73

1 Which is the softest?
(A) p (B) pp (C) mp

2 mf means…
(A) very loud (B) half soft (C) half loud

3 A hairpin that opens means…
(A) getting softer (B) getting faster (C) getting louder

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.73

E2 Touch: smooth, short, strong

Handbook p.76

1 A dot above or below a note means...
(A) short (staccato) (B) stronger (accent) (C) hold it longer

2 A curve over different notes means...
(A) hold them twice as long (B) play them twice (C) join them smoothly

3 A line (tenuto) over a note means...
(A) hold it its full length (B) play it short (C) play it very loud

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.76

E3 Speed words

Handbook p.79

1 Andante means...
(A) very slow (B) very fast (C) at a walking pace

2 rit. means...
(A) back to the first speed (B) gradually slower (C) gradually faster

3 ♩ = 60 means...
(A) 60 notes in a bar (B) 60 bars in the piece (C) 60 beats in a minute

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.79

E4 The pedals

Handbook p.82

1 Ped. means...
(A) press the right pedal down (B) press the left pedal down (C) play louder

2 On a new chord, you change the pedal...
(A) only at the end (B) just after you play it (C) just before you play it

3 u.c. (una corda) means...
(A) lift every pedal (B) use the right pedal (C) use the left, soft pedal

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.82

E5 Ornaments

Handbook p.85

1 A trill on E goes back and forth between E and...
(A) F (B) D (C) G

2 A tiny note with a slash (acciaccatura) is...
(A) crushed in, as fast as possible (B) played after the main note (C) held for half the main note

3 A turn on D is played...
(A) C D E (B) D E D (C) E D C D

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.85

Part IV · Scales and keys

S1 Major scales

Handbook p.90

1 Every major scale follows the pattern…
(A) T T T S T T S (B) T T S T T T S (C) T S T T S T T

2 In T T S T T T S, a T (tone) has…
(A) two keys between (B) no key between (C) one key between

3 In every major scale, the semitones fall between notes…
(A) 4–5 and 7–8 (B) 2–3 and 5–6 (C) 3–4 and 7–8

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.90

S2 Minor scales

Handbook p.93

1 C natural minor is C major with which notes one key lower?
(A) only 3 (B) 3, 6 and 7 (C) 2, 4 and 6

2 The harmonic minor is the natural minor with…
(A) the 3rd raised one key (B) the 7th raised one key (C) the 6th and 7th lowered one key

3 The melodic minor coming down is the same as…
(A) the harmonic minor (B) the natural minor (C) the major scale

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.93

S3 Keys and key signatures

Handbook p.96

1 A key signature applies to…
(A) the next note only (B) every note of that name, all through (C) the first bar only

2 One sharp, F♯, is G major or…
(A) A minor (B) E minor (C) D minor

3 The order of sharps begins…
(A) C G D (B) B E A (C) F C G

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.96

S4 Finding the key

Handbook p.99

1 With sharps, the major key is…
(A) the very next key up from the last sharp (B) the last sharp itself (C) the first sharp

2 With flats, the major key is…
(A) the last flat (B) the second-last flat (C) the first flat

3 One sharp, D♯s all through, ending on E: the key is…
(A) G major (B) E minor (C) D major

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.99

S5 The circle of fifths

Handbook p.102

1 Going right (clockwise) round the circle adds...
(A) two sharps (B) one flat (C) one sharp

2 The major key with one flat is...
(A) G major (B) F major (C) B♭ major

3 Next to C major on the circle are...
(A) G major and F major (B) D major and B♭ major (C) A major and E major

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.102

Part V · Chords

H1 Chords and triads

Handbook p.107

1 A triad is built by...
(A) three keys in a row (B) three black keys (C) play one, skip one, play one

2 The notes of the C major triad are...
(A) C D E (B) C F A (C) C E G

3 The note a chord is named after is its...
(A) 3rd (B) 5th (C) root

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.107

H2 Four kinds of triad

Handbook p.110

1 In a major triad, the keys between (root to 3rd, 3rd to 5th) are...
(A) 3 + 2 (B) 2 + 2 (C) 2 + 3

2 A triad with 2 + 2 keys between is...
(A) augmented (B) minor (C) diminished

3 C E♭ G is...
(A) C major (B) C minor (C) C diminished

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.110

H3 Chords in a key

Handbook p.113

1 In C major, chord V is...
(A) G (B) A minor (C) F

2 Capital Roman numerals (I, IV, V) are...
(A) minor chords (B) seventh chords (C) major chords

3 In C major, chord ii is...
(A) D minor (B) E minor (C) D major

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.113

H4 Inversions

Handbook p.116

1 E G C is the C chord in...
(A) 1st inversion (B) root position (C) 2nd inversion

2 In 2nd inversion, the bottom note is the...
(A) 5th (B) root (C) 3rd

3 An inversion keeps the chord's name but changes...
(A) the kind of chord (B) the root (C) the bottom note

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.116

H5 Seventh chords

Handbook p.119

1 G7 is...
(A) G B♭ D F (B) G B D F♯ (C) G B D F

2 A seventh chord adds to the triad...
(A) one more 3rd on top (B) a note below (C) a 2nd above the root

3 Cmaj7 is...
(A) C E G B (B) C E G B♭ (C) C E♭ G B♭

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.119

H6 Colour chords

Handbook p.122

1 Csus4 is...
(A) C D G (B) C F G (C) C E G A

2 A power chord, C5, is...
(A) C E G (B) C F G (C) C and G only

3 C6 is...
(A) C E G B (B) C E G D (C) C E G A

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.122

H7 The tower: 9, 11, 13

Handbook p.125

1 The 9th has the same letter name as the...
(A) 6th (B) 4th (C) 2nd

2 The 13th has the same letter name as the...
(A) 6th (B) 5th (C) 3rd

3 C9 is...
(A) C E G A (B) C E G B♭ D (C) C E G D

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.125

H8 Slash chords

Handbook p.128

1 C/E means...
(A) only C and E (B) a C chord, then an E chord (C) a C chord with E as the lowest note

2 In G/B the bass note is...
(A) B (B) D (C) G

3 In F/G the bass note G is...
(A) the root of the F chord (B) not a note of the F chord (C) the 3rd of the F chord

Right: ☐ / 3 3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.128

Part VI · Harmony in music

M1 Chords from outside the key

Handbook p.133

1 In C major, D F♯ A has the guest note...
(A) A (B) D (C) F♯

2 A sharp guest note usually moves...
(A) nowhere (B) up one key (C) down one key

3 In C major, the A♭ in F minor (F A♭ C) usually moves...
(A) up two keys, to B♭ (B) up one key, to A (C) down one key, to G

Right: ☐ / 3 3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.133

M2 Cadences

Handbook p.136

1 V to I is a...
(A) plagal cadence (B) perfect cadence (C) interrupted cadence

2 IV to I (the “Amen”) is a...
(A) perfect cadence (B) plagal cadence (C) imperfect cadence

3 A phrase that ends on V has an...
(A) plagal cadence (B) imperfect cadence (C) perfect cadence

Right: ☐ / 3 3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.136

M3 Chords under a melody

Handbook p.139

1 To choose a chord for a bar, look at...
(A) its main notes (strong beats, long notes) (B) its last note only (C) its lowest note

2 In C major, a bar whose main notes are D and B takes chord...
(A) V (B) IV (C) I

3 An Alberti bass on C plays...
(A) C E G E (B) C G E G (C) C C G G

Right: ☐ / 3 3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.139

M4 Progressions everywhere

Handbook p.141

1 The pop four in C (I V vi IV) is...
(A) C G Am F (B) C Am F G (C) C F G C

2 The twelve-bar blues starts with...
(A) four bars of V (B) four bars of I (C) I IV V I

3 ii V I in C is...
(A) Dm G C (B) Em F C (C) D G C

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.141

Part VII · Shape and style

F1 Motifs and phrases

Handbook p.145

1 A motif is...
(A) a whole piece (B) a speed word (C) a short idea that comes back

2 Most phrases are...
(A) 16 bars long (B) 4 bars long (C) 1 bar long

3 In C major, a phrase that ends on D sounds like a...
(A) question (B) answer (C) full stop

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.145

F2 Repetition and sequence

Handbook p.147

1 C D E, then D E F is...
(A) a sequence (B) a contrast (C) a repetition

2 The left hand copying the right hand a bar later is...
(A) a contrast (B) imitation (C) a sequence

3 C D E, then C D E again is...
(A) imitation (B) repetition (C) a sequence

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.147

F3 Texture

Handbook p.149

1 A tune with block chords underneath is...
(A) homophonic (B) monophonic (C) polyphonic

2 Two independent tunes at once is...
(A) homophonic (B) monophonic (C) polyphonic

3 One line alone, with no chords, is...
(A) polyphonic (B) homophonic (C) monophonic

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.149

F4 Changing key

Handbook p.151

1 In C major, an F♯ that keeps coming back usually means the music has moved to...
(A) G major (B) D minor (C) F major

2 A modulation is...
(A) a change of time signature (B) a change of speed (C) a change of key

3 One passing F♯ in a bar of C major is...
(A) a decoration, not a new key (B) always a new key (C) a mistake

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.151

F5 Form

Handbook p.153

1 A B A is...
(A) binary form (B) rondo form (C) ternary form

2 A B A C A is...
(A) ternary form (B) theme and variations (C) rondo form

3 A A^1 A^2 A^3 is...
(A) theme and variations (B) strophic form (C) rondo form

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.153

F6 Styles through time

Handbook p.156

1 Bach belongs to the...
(A) Romantic period (B) Baroque period (C) Classical period

2 An Alberti bass and tidy 4-bar phrases suggest the...
(A) Baroque period (B) Modern period (C) Classical period

3 Rubato and rich pedalling suggest the...
(A) Classical period (B) Baroque period (C) Romantic period

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.156

Part VIII · Playing and listening

L1 Fingering

Handbook p.160

1 In both hands, the thumb is finger...
(A) 1 (B) 0 (C) 5

2 Right hand, C major going up: after finger 3 on E, the F is played by...
(A) the thumb, passing under (B) finger 4 (C) finger 5

3 Right-hand thumb on C, five-finger position: G is finger...
(A) 5 (B) 3 (C) 4

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.160

L2 Practising well

Handbook p.162

1 Which bar should you practise first?
(A) the first one (B) the easiest one (C) the hardest one

2 When do you set the metronome one notch faster?
(A) after one try (B) after three correct times in a row (C) never

3 Practising fast with mistakes...
(A) is the quickest way to learn (B) does no harm (C) teaches your fingers the mistakes

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.162

L3 Sight-reading

Handbook p.164

1 Before you sight-read, check first...
(A) the key and time signatures (B) the title only (C) the last bar

2 A wrong note while sight-reading: you...
(A) stop and start again (B) keep the beat going (C) go back one bar

3 Choose a speed that...
(A) is as fast as possible (B) you can keep all the way (C) is exactly the marked speed

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.164

L4 Listening

Handbook p.166

1 In Twinkle, the 2nd to the 3rd note (“twin-kle TWIN”) is a...
(A) octave (B) perfect 5th (C) major 3rd

2 A minor chord usually sounds...
(A) darker than a major chord (B) exactly like a major chord (C) brighter than a major chord

3 A phrase that stops on chord V sounds...
(A) louder (B) not finished (C) finished

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.166

L5 Performing

Handbook p.168

1 Before the first note, you...
(A) breathe and feel a bar of the beat (B) look at the audience (C) start at once

2 After a slip in a performance, you...
(A) keep going and rejoin on the next beat (B) go back and fix it (C) stop and say sorry

3 Nerves before you play...
(A) mean you are not ready (B) are normal (C) should stop you playing

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.168

THE HANDBOOK CHECK

Answers

One line per chapter: question number and letter. Count your right answers and write the score in the chapter's box.

P1	1A 2A 3C	**P2**	1A 2B 3B	**P3**	1B 2B 3B	**P4**	1C 2B 3B
P5	1A 2A 3A	**P6**	1A 2B 3C	**P7**	1A 2C 3B	**T1**	1A 2B 3B
T2	1B 2B 3A	**T3**	1A 2A 3A	**T4**	1A 2C 3A	**T5**	1C 2A 3C
T6	1C 2B 3C	**T7**	1C 2B 3C	**T8**	1C 2B 3A	**E1**	1B 2C 3C
E2	1A 2C 3A	**E3**	1C 2B 3C	**E4**	1A 2B 3C	**E5**	1A 2A 3C
S1	1B 2C 3C	**S2**	1B 2B 3B	**S3**	1B 2B 3C	**S4**	1A 2B 3B
S5	1C 2B 3A	**H1**	1C 2C 3C	**H2**	1A 2C 3B	**H3**	1A 2C 3A
H4	1A 2A 3C	**H5**	1C 2A 3A	**H6**	1B 2C 3C	**H7**	1C 2A 3B
H8	1C 2A 3B	**M1**	1C 2B 3C	**M2**	1B 2B 3B	**M3**	1A 2A 3B
M4	1A 2B 3A	**F1**	1C 2B 3A	**F2**	1A 2B 3B	**F3**	1A 2C 3C
F4	1A 2C 3A	**F5**	1C 2C 3A	**F6**	1B 2C 3C	**L1**	1A 2A 3A
L2	1C 2B 3C	**L3**	1A 2B 3B	**L4**	1B 2A 3B	**L5**	1A 2A 3B

THE HANDBOOK CHECK

My map

Colour one circle for each chapter you check. Green chapters you can skip; yellow ones skim; red ones are where you start. Check again in a few months and watch the map turn green.

○ skip it (3) ○ skim it (2) ○ study it (0–1)

Part I · Pitch

P1	The keyboard	p.22	○ ○ ○
P2	The staff and the clefs	p.27	○ ○ ○
P3	The staff and the keyboard	p.29	○ ○ ○
P4	Reading the notes	p.32	○ ○ ○
P5	Sharps, flats and naturals	p.36	○ ○ ○
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P7	Major, minor and perfect	p.42	○ ○ ○

Part II · Time

T1	Pulse, tempo and the bar	p.47	○ ○ ○
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T3	How long is a note?	p.53	○ ○ ○
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